

Entering Night: Moishe's Warning and the Symbol of Night

Night by Elie Wiesel, pp. 3–22 (print file: PDF pages 18–36) · Standards 8.T.C.2.c · 8.T.T.1.a · 8.T.SS.2.a · 8.T.SS.1.d

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What does the community's reaction to the warning reveal about human nature, and what might Wiesel's repeated word "night" come to symbolize?

LEARNING TARGET

I can analyze how the people of Sighet respond to warnings and how Wiesel begins to use the word "night" as a symbol, and use evidence from the text to explain what those patterns reveal.

THE DISTINCTION · POST IT, KEEP IT UP ALL PERIOD

WARNING → REACTION → INFERENCE. The warning is what the town is told. The reaction is what they do with it. The inference is what that reveals about **people**. And for night: **LITERAL → PATTERN → SYMBOL.** The sorting question all period: "Are you telling me what happened, or what it reveals?"

HOMEWORK = FIRST READ · CLASS = REREAD

Scholars read pp. 3–22 last night with the Opening Reading Check. Today is not a second first-read. Class reconstructs the plot fast, rereads the moment that matters (Moishe, pp. 5–7), and spends the time on inference, symbolism, discussion, and writing.

RUN OF SHOW · 80 MINUTES · REAL TEACHING + REAL DEBRIEFS

0–5	Timed Do Now · Moishe's warning from last night's reading	p. 1 · Box 01	Slide 2
5–15	Go over Do Now + homework debrief · sequence the escalation	p. 1 · homework sheet	Slide 3
15–20	Play vs. memoir · Wiesel framing · the two lenses	p. 1 · Box 02	Slides 4–5
20–30	Targeted reread pp. 5–7 (20–25) · model Moishe row, warning + reaction (25–30)	p. 2 · Row M	Slides 6–7
30–34	★ LEAF scholar think-aloud → second scholar → draft the inference together	p. 2 · purple strip	Slide 8
34–44	Partners: warning rows 2–3	p. 2 · Rows 2–3	Slide 9
44–50	Go over the warning chart · human nature discussion	p. 2	Slide 9
50–56	Teach symbolism · model one Night Tracker row	p. 3 · Row M	Slide 10
56–64	Scholars: Night Tracker rows	p. 3 · Rows 2–4	Slide 10
64–69	Go over the night pattern · pattern sentence	p. 3 · pattern	Slide 10
69–77	Focused analytical write (claim + evidence + reasoning)	p. 4 · Box 05	Slide 11
77–80	Exit ticket (you choose A or B) · collect · pack-up	p. 5 · Box 06	Slide 12

Running long? Do fewer Night Tracker rows (rows 2–3 only), or finish the focused write for homework. **Never cut** the homework debrief, the Moishe reread, your modeling, the scholar think-aloud, the warning inference, or symbolism instruction.

★ LEAF ACTION STEP · PLANNED SCHOLAR THINK-ALOUD

When: 30–34, right after the class rereads Moishe’s return and names how the community responded (Row M, columns 1–2), before anyone writes the inference. **Moment:** “Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction reveal about people?” **Protocol:** 30–45 sec silent think → Scholar 1: **First I noticed... Then I noticed the people... So I decided this reveals... Because...** → Scholar 2: “I agree / would revise that because ____.” → draft the inference together → release. Press, don’t answer: “What detail made you think that?” · “Are you explaining what happened, or what it reveals?” · “What does this tell us about how people respond to unbearable information?”

MILESTONES ALIGNMENT · BRIEF

No separate argument task. The focused write already practices it: **claim** = what you are arguing about people or about night, **evidence** = the line or detail that proves it, **reasoning** = why that evidence supports the claim. Label the three moves; don’t add an activity.

PRECISION VOCABULARY PRATHER

memoir · symbolism · foreshadowing · indifference · deportation

WHAT CHANGED FROM PRATHER (AND WHY)

Prather’s objective, EQ, two lenses, Warning Reactions Chart, Night Tracker, and both writing prompts are kept. **The first read of pp. 3–22 moved to guided homework**, so class time goes to rereading, teaching, discussion, and writing instead of 20 pages of silent reading. The opener is a **5-minute content Do Now + a real 10-minute homework debrief**; the play-to-memoir shift is a 5-minute teaching moment after it. Prather’s read-aloud of pp. 3–7 became a **targeted reread of pp. 5–7**. Prather’s 30-minute draft + self-revise became an **~8–10 minute claim / evidence / reasoning write** (finish at home if needed). The exit ticket uses your two versions. Page numbers are the printed book pages; Prather’s Night pages match this edition.

PREP CHECKLIST

- ☐ Night before: every scholar leaves with **PDF pages 18–36** (book pp. 3–22) + the Opening Reading Check
- ☐ Extra printed reading for scholars who forgot theirs
- ☐ Two anchor charts: **WARNING → REACTION → INFERENCE** and a blank **NIGHT** chart. Do not prewrite a symbol.
- ☐ Partners set (strong reader with a scholar who may not have read)
- ☐ Pick your think-aloud scholar + a backup
- ☐ Visible timer · doc cam on the packet
- ☐ Decide by ~70:00 which exit ticket (A warnings or B night) fits how the block went

PAGES

Assigned	Book pp. 3–22 = PDF pages 18–36 of your print file. Prather's Night pages match this edition.
Reread	pp. 5–7 : the end of Moishe's lessons, the expulsion, his return, and the town's refusal.
Warnings	Row 2 → pp. 8–9 · Row 3 → pp. 9–12
Night	Model p. 12 · then p. 14 · p. 18 · p. 21 · p. 22
Other copy	In the two-pages-per-sheet PDF, book pp. 3–22 are PDF pages 14–24.

THE ESCALATION · SEQUENCE FOR THE DEBRIEF

Moishe's warning (end of 1942, pp. 6–7) → outside danger grows: Fascists take power, German troops enter Hungary, the Budapest report (spring 1944, pp. 8–9) → German soldiers arrive in Sighet (p. 9) → restrictions: leaders arrested, valuables seized, the yellow star, new edicts (pp. 10–11) → the ghettos (p. 11) → "Transports" (p. 13).

HOMEWORK ANSWER KEY · OPENING READING CHECK

- 1 Moishe is the poor "jack-of-all-trades" of the Hasidic house of prayer (p. 3). He becomes Elie's teacher in Kabbalah and teaches him the power of questions: "Man comes closer to God through the questions he asks Him" (p. 5).
- 2 Expelled as a foreigner in cattle cars (p. 6). In Polish territory the Gestapo forced the Jews to dig trenches and shot them, using infants as targets. Moishe was wounded and left for dead (p. 6). He comes back and goes house to house telling it (p. 7).
- 3 They refused to believe and refused to listen; said he wanted pity, was imagining things, or had gone mad (p. 7). Even Elie: "all I felt was pity" (p. 7).
- 4 Interpretation. Accept: too horrible to imagine; they want normal life; he is an easy person to dismiss; the radio news sounds encouraging (pp. 7–8). Press anything that only says "they were dumb."
- 5 As printed: soldiers **2** · ghettos **4** · Moishe **1** · leaders arrested / restrictions **3**
- 6 Any with a page: "Hitler will not be able to harm us" (p. 8) · "Optimism soon revived" (p. 9) · the chocolates, "Where is their famous cruelty?" (p. 10) · "The yellow star? So what? It's not lethal..." (p. 11) · the ghetto "ruled by delusion" (p. 12) · "people clung to hope" (p. 15) · deportation as a "vacation" (p. 21)
- 7 Night appears on pp. 12, 14, 18, 21, 22.
- 8 Any. Skim the A's (confusions) at the door; they tell you what to clear up in the debrief.

WARNING REACTIONS KEY

M · pp. 6–7	Moishe's eyewitness account. They refuse to believe or listen; call him mad (p. 7).	People may doubt the messenger rather than accept news too terrible to imagine. Disbelief protects their normal life.
2 · pp. 8–9	Fascists seize power; German troops enter Hungary; the Budapest report. "Yet we still were not worried... it was all in the abstract" (p. 9). "Optimism soon revived" (p. 9).	People keep danger "abstract" until it touches them. Hope can become a way of not looking.
3 · pp. 9–12	German soldiers arrive; the officer brings chocolates (p. 10). Leaders arrested; Moishe: "I warned you" (p. 10). "It's not lethal..." (p. 11). The ghetto "ruled by delusion" (p. 12).	People adjust to each new step and call it normal. Small kindnesses and gradual change make it easier to deny the danger.

NIGHT TRACKER KEY · DO NOT POST THESE

p. 12	"Night fell." Father summoned; the story "would remain unfinished."	The ordinary evening breaks; the start of the end of safety.
p. 14	Someone knocked "that night": "we might still have been able to flee."	A last warning lost; too late; escape cut off.
p. 18	"Night had fallen." "It was to be the last night spent in our house."	Losing home; endings.
p. 21	"NIGHT. No one was praying for the night to pass quickly." Stars as sparks of a fire "consuming us."	Destruction; fear; hope fading.
p. 22	The last family meal; "I spent that night going over memories."	The last of family life; sleeplessness, dread.

Stretch press: on p. 3 night meant running to the synagogue to pray ("by night I would run to the synagogue"). What changes about night by p. 21?

MISCONCEPTIONS → CLARIFY (ASK BEFORE YOU RESCUE)

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|--|
| 1 Summary = inference. | "You told me what happened. What does it reveal about people?" |
| 2 "The town was just stupid." | "That is a judgment. What does the text actually show about WHY they dismiss the danger?" |
| 3 Night only means nighttime. | "Literally, yes. Now look at what keeps happening around the word. What larger idea is beginning to travel with it?" |
| 4 The symbol has one official answer. | "Can you defend your interpretation from the pattern in the text?" |
| 5 Evidence with no reasoning. | "You found the line. What does it prove?" |

For #2, push toward **denial, disbelief, optimism, self-protection, abstraction, or not being able to imagine the scale**, when the text supports it. p. 8: "Annihilate an entire people?... In the middle of the twentieth century!"

BRIGGS CHECKS · WARNING ROWS

1 Warning: "What exactly were they told?" · **2 Reaction:** "What did they actually do or say? Page?" · **3 Inference:** "You told me what they did. What does that reveal?" · **4** "What are they protecting themselves from having to believe?" · **5** "At what point does disbelief become dangerous?"

WHEN A SCHOLAR STRUGGLES

"Talk me through how you got there." → "What part are you sure about?" → "Go back to the text. What made you say that?" → "Okay. So what?" → then clarify if you need to.

MOREHOUSE · SAME PACKET, SAME ENDPOINT

Built in: pre-flagged page ranges for every row, the warning + reaction already written in Row M, the night page bank, "Talk first," and limited stems on p. 4. Live moves: point to the exact paragraph (Row 2: p. 9, "Yet we still were not worried"; Row 3: p. 10, the chocolates; p. 11, "It's not lethal"). One minute of oral rehearsal before the write. **Never write the inference or the symbol for them.**

PACKET PAGE 1 · BOX 01

DAY 1 · Anna + Peter
DAY 2 · Tone + Mood
DAY 3 · Theme + Legacy
DAY 4 · Entering Night
DAY 5 · Writing Synthesis
DAY 4

ENTERING NIGHT: MOISHE'S WARNING AND THE SYMBOL OF NIGHT

Night by Elie Wiesel · pp. 3-22 · plus last night's reading check

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

LEARNING TARGET
I can analyze how the people of Sighet respond to warnings and how Wiesel begins to use the word "night" as a symbol, and use evidence from the text to explain what those patterns reveal.

01 **DO NOW** 5 MIN
Silent. On your own. Use last night's reading.

Moishe returns to Sighet to warn the community about what he witnessed. **What does the community do with his warning, and WHY do you think they respond that way?** Use one detail from last night's reading.

MY RESPONSE

HOMEWORK COMPLETED? ☐ YES ☐ NO

02 **FROM PLAY TO MEMOIR** QUICK REFERENCE
Same history. A different way of telling it.

PLAY
Playwrights shape a story for an audience. We experience the characters from the **outside**: dialogue, stage directions, performance.

MEMOIR
A survivor tells his **own** lived experience through memory and purpose. We are **inside** the narrator's perspective.

LENS 1 · ABOUT PEOPLE
How does this town respond every time danger gets closer?

LENS 2 · ABOUT LANGUAGE
What does Wiesel begin doing with the word "night"?

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 1 OF 5

GET THEM HERE

Classwork packet on desks, p. 1. Homework sheet and printed reading out, on top. Slide 2. Timer at **5:00**.

SAY WHILE DOING

(Slide 2) "Alright, look here. Homework sheet and your reading on top of your desk. Box 01. Moishe comes back to Sighet to warn them. What does the community do with his warning, and **why** do you think they respond that way? One detail from last night. Five minutes. Silent. Then circle YES or NO for homework." Start the timer.

SCHOLARS DO

Write silently for the full five minutes, using the reading and their homework. Circle the homework check.

CHECK

Walk the room with a clipboard. Four quick reads: **read?** (homework done) · **understood?** (they know what Moishe saw) · **evidence?** (a detail or page) · **inferring?** (a real "why"). Note two or three strong "why" answers to call on.

IF STALLED

"Open to p. 7. Find what the people say about Moishe. Start there." · "What did they call him?"

IF THEY DIDN'T READ

Don't stop the room. Hand them the printed reading open to p. 7: "Read this page and answer from it." Deal with the homework after class.

MOVE ON WHEN

The timer hits 0. Don't extend; the debrief is where you teach.

TRANSITION

(Slide 3) "Pencils down. Homework sheet out. We're going to put last night's reading back together, fast. Fix or add to your answers while we talk."

5–15 MIN

GO OVER THE DO NOW + HOMEWORK DEBRIEF

Rebuild pp. 3–11 together · scholars correct their homework as they listen · focus on the escalation

PACKET P. 1 · HOMEWORK SHEET

SLIDE 3

PACKET PAGE 1 · BOX 01 (HOMEWORK SHEET BESIDE IT)

DAY 1: Anne & Peter · DAY 2: Tense & Mood · DAY 3: Theme & Logos · DAY 4: Entering Night · DAY 5: Writing Synthesis · DAY 6

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Night by Elie Wiesel · pp. 3–22 · plus last night's reading check

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WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 1 OF 5

What is happening, pp. 3–11

Sighet, 1941–1944. Elie, almost 13, studies with Moishe the Beadle. Moishe is deported, survives a mass shooting, and returns to warn the town (end of 1942). Nobody believes him. Through 1943 life feels normal. In spring 1944 the danger gets closer step by step, and each time the town finds a reason to stay calm.

ASK · 1 “What happened to Moishe?” (homework #2)**LISTEN FOR** Expelled in cattle cars; the Gestapo shot the Jews in a forest; he was wounded and left for dead (p. 6).**ASK · 2** “What did he come back trying to do?”**LISTEN FOR** Warn them: “I wanted to come back to warn you” (p. 7). He goes house to house, “day after day, night after night” (p. 7).**ASK · 3** “How did the people respond?” Take 2 answers, each with a page.**LISTEN FOR** Refused to believe, refused to listen; said he wanted pity, was imagining things, had gone mad (p. 7).**ASK · 4** “**Why** do you think they responded that way?” (homework #4). Take 2–3. Don’t judge yet. “Hold onto those. We’re coming back to them.”**IF INCOMPLETE** “They were dumb.” → “That’s a judgment. What does the text show about why?”
· No page → “Where did you see that?”**SEQUENCE · 3 MIN**

(Slide 3, homework #5) “Order check.” Build it on the board as they call it out:
Moishe’s warning → danger grows outside (Hungary) → German soldiers arrive → restrictions → ghettos. “Every step is closer. Watch what the town does at every step. That’s today.”

SCHOLARS DO Listen, then fix or add to their homework in a different color.**MOVE ON WHEN** The class can say the escalation in order. Don’t reteach every plot detail; ten minutes max.**TRANSITION** | (Slide 4) “**Before we go back into the text, notice what kind of book this is. Yesterday we finished a play. This is something different. Box 02.**”

PACKET PAGE 1 · BOX 02

DAY 1: Anne + Peter DAY 2: Tone + Mood DAY 3: Theme + Legacy DAY 4: Entering Night DAY 5: Writing Synthesis DAY 4

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Night by Elie Wiesel · pp. 3–22 · plus last night's reading check

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WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 1 OF 5

SAY WHILE DOING

(Slide 4, point to the two columns) "In a play, playwrights shape a story for an audience. We experienced Anne from the **outside**: dialogue, stage directions, performance. A memoir is a survivor telling his **own** lived experience, through memory and purpose. We are **inside** his perspective." **PRATHER**

ASK "What can a memoir give us that a play cannot?" **PRATHER** Take 2.

LISTEN FOR His thoughts and feelings; it really happened to him; we hear his voice; he knows how it ends and is looking back.

IF INCOMPLETE "Find a sentence from last night that a play couldn't show you." Point them to p. 11: "(Poor Father! Of what then did you die?)" That's the survivor's voice, looking back from after.

WIESEL · 1 MIN "Elie Wiesel was born in Sighet, the town you just read about. He was a teenager when these events happened. He survived, and his writing became testimony: a record, so people remember." Stop there.

TWO LENSES (Slide 5) "Track two things: how this town responds every time danger gets closer, and what Wiesel begins doing with the word **night**. One is about people. One is about language. Both tell us what is coming."

PRATHER

KEEP IT SHORT Don't pre-summarize the rest of the memoir. The opening's calm is part of how Wiesel built the escalation. **PRATHER**

MOVE ON WHEN 20:00. One honest answer about what memoir can do is enough.

TRANSITION (Slide 6) "Lens one first. Printed reading, p. 5. We're rereading Moishe's return slowly, because this is the moment the whole opening turns on."

20–25 MIN

TARGETED REREAD · MOISHE'S WARNING, PP. 5–7

Prather direct instruction · read slowly · warning + reaction first, the inference comes from scholars next

PRINTED READING pp. 5–7

PACKET P. 2 · ANNOTATION KEY

SLIDE 6

PACKET PAGE 2 · ANNOTATION KEY

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

03 WARNING REACTIONS CHART
Warning → reaction → what the reaction reveals about people. LENS 1

REREAD pp. 5–7. Mark your printed pages: **W** warning, **R** reaction, **?** something to discuss. **Column 3 is not a summary.** It answers: what does this reaction reveal about what people do with unbearable news?

THE WARNING + PAGE	THE COMMUNITY'S REACTION + PAGE	INFERENCE: WHAT THIS REVEALS ABOUT PEOPLE
M pp. 6–7 · MOISHE Moishe escapes the Galician forest and comes back to describe what the Gestapo did there: "I wanted to come back to warn you." (p. 7)	People "not only refused to believe his tales, they refused to listen." Some said he wanted pity or was imagining things. Others said he had gone mad. (p. 7)	<i>We build this one together.</i>

SHOW YOUR THINKING · THINK FIRST, THEN SAY IT
Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction to Moishe reveal about people?

FIRST I NOTICED...	THEN I NOTICED THE PEOPLE...	SO I DECIDED THIS REVEALS...	BECAUSE...
BUILD · REVISE · CHALLENGE "I agree / would revise that because _____."			

PARTNERS · TALK IT OUT TOGETHER, EACH OF YOU WRITES

2 LOOK ON pp. 8–9 the war news, the Fascists take power, German troops enter Hungary, the report from Budapest		
3 LOOK ON pp. 9–12 German soldiers arrive in Sighet, the leaders are arrested, new decrees, the ghettos		

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 2 OF 5

Grounding · Moishe's return (pp. 6–7)

What is happening: The authorities expel the town's foreign Jews, Moishe among them. In Polish territory the Gestapo forces them to dig trenches and shoots them. Moishe is wounded, left for dead, and makes it back. He goes house to house begging people to listen.

Why it matters: Moishe is the witness nobody believes **PRATHER**. His warning comes at the end of 1942, more than a year before the Germans reach Sighet (spring 1944). There was time. The town uses it to go back to normal.

GET THEM HERE Printed reading open to p. 5, pencil in hand. Packet p. 2. Slide 6.

SAY WHILE DOING

"As I read, mark the margin. **W** for a warning. **R** for a reaction. **?** for something you want to talk about. That's it, three marks."

READ ALOUD

From p. 5, the last lessons ("And Moishe the Beadle, the poorest of the poor of Sighet..."), through p. 6 ("AND THEN, one day all foreign Jews were expelled"), to the bottom of p. 7 ("This was toward the end of 1942."). **Slow down** on p. 7: "Moishe was not the same. The joy in his eyes was gone." Pause after "Only no one is listening to me..."

ASK "What changed in Moishe?" Then: "Where did you put your R's?"

LISTEN FOR

He stopped singing, stopped talking about God; he only talks about what he saw (p. 7). R's: "refused to believe... refused to listen," wanted pity, imagining things, "gone mad" (p. 7). Also p. 6: "The deportees were quickly forgotten."

MOVE ON WHEN About 25:00. Scholars can say what Moishe saw and how the town answered.

TRANSITION

(Slide 7) "Packet, page 2, Row M. Let's put that on the chart."

PACKET PAGE 2 · ROW M

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

03 WARNING REACTIONS CHART
Warning → reaction → what the reaction reveals about people. LENS 3

REREAD pp. 5–7. Mark your printed pages: **W** warning
R reaction **?** something to discuss

Column 3 is not a summary. It answers: what does this reaction reveal about what people do with unbearable news?

THE WARNING + PAGE	THE COMMUNITY'S REACTION + PAGE	INFERENCE: WHAT THIS REVEALS ABOUT PEOPLE
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SHOW YOUR THINKING · THINK FIRST, THEN SAY IT Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction to Moishe reveal about people?		
FIRST I NOTICED...	THEN I NOTICED THE PEOPLE...	SO I DECIDED THIS REVEALS...
BECAUSE...		
BUILD · REVISE · CHALLENGE "I agree / would revise that because ____"		
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WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 2 OF 5

MODEL · ROW M

(Slide 7, doc cam on Row M) "Column one, the warning: Moishe's eyewitness account of the shootings, p. 6, and why he came back, p. 7. Column two, the reaction: they refused to believe, refused to listen, called him mad, p. 7. Those two are already in your packet. Column three is the one that matters. The third column is not a summary. It answers: what does this reaction reveal about what people do with unbearable news?" **PRATHER**

CONNECT

"We already studied disbelief and indifference as conditions that helped persecution grow. Now Wiesel is showing us what that looks like inside one town."

MOVE ON WHEN

30:00. Columns 1–2 are understood; column 3 is still empty on purpose.

TRANSITION

(Slide 8) "Don't write column three yet. Purple strip, right under Row M. I want to hear how you think."

Grounding · what column 3 can say

Watch for: "Even I did not believe him" (p. 7). The narrator includes himself, so this isn't just "those people."

The text supports: disbelief as self-protection; news too terrible to imagine; a poor outsider is easy to dismiss.

30–34 MIN

★ LEAF SCHOLAR THINK-ALLOUD — OBSERVATION LOOK-FOR

Right after scholars name how the town responded to Moishe · before anyone writes the inference

PACKET P. 2 · PURPLE STRIP

SLIDE 8

PACKET PAGE 2 · SHOW YOUR THINKING

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

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Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction to Moishe reveal about people?

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WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 2 OF 5

★ What an observer should see

The teacher models columns 1–2, then **scholars do the inference thinking out loud**. The teacher presses with questions and doesn't supply the answer. A second scholar builds on, revises, or challenges before the class writes.

Model warning + reaction (20–30)

Silent think 30–45 sec

Scholar 1 thinks aloud

Scholar 2 builds / revises / challenges

Draft the inference together

Before class: think-aloud scholar _____ · backup _____

1 · ASK

"Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction reveal about people?"

2 · SILENT THINK

"Don't write. Don't talk. Thumb on your chest when you have your 'First I noticed...' " **Wait the full 30–45 seconds.**

3 · SCHOLAR 1

"[Name], talk us through it. 'First I noticed _____. Then I noticed the people _____. So I decided this reveals ____ because ____.'"

LISTEN FOR

"First I noticed Moishe was telling them something horrible. Then I noticed the people called him crazy instead of asking questions. So I decided this reveals that people would rather doubt the messenger than believe something that terrible, because believing it would mean their whole life is in danger."

PRESS, DON'T ANSWER

"What detail made you think that?" · "Are you explaining what happened, or what it reveals?" · "What does this tell us about how people respond to unbearable information?" Stuck → "What part are you sure about?" **Stay with the same scholar.**

4 · SCHOLAR 2

"Who can build on, revise, or challenge that?" Stem: "I agree / would revise that because ____."

LISTEN FOR

A revision that adds the *why*: "I'd add that it lets them keep their normal life, because right after, p. 7 says life 'seemed normal once again.'" → "That's an inference with evidence."

5 · LAND IT

Draft one inference sentence for Row M column 3 together; scholars write it. "Good. That difference matters today. We are not just tracking what happens. We are asking what the reactions reveal."

TRANSITION

(Slide 9) "Your turn with a partner. Rows 2 and 3. The pages are flagged for you."

PACKET PAGE 2 · ROWS 2–3

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

03 WARNING REACTIONS CHART
Warning → reaction → what the reaction reveals about people. LENS 3

REREAD pp. 5–7. Mark your printed pages: **W** warning **R** reaction **I** something to discuss. Column 3 is not a summary. It answers: what does this reaction reveal about what people do with unbearable news?

THE WARNING + PAGE	THE COMMUNITY'S REACTION + PAGE	INFERENCE: WHAT THIS REVEALS ABOUT PEOPLE
M pp. 6–7 · MOISHE Moishe escapes the Galician forest and comes back to describe what the Gestapo did there: "I wanted to come back to warn you." (p. 7)	People "not only refused to believe his tales, they refused to listen." Some said he wanted pity or was imagining things. Others said he had gone mad. (p. 7)	We build this one together.

SHOW YOUR THINKING · THINK FIRST, THEN SAY IT
Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction to Moishe reveal about people?

FIRST I NOTICED...	THEN I NOTICED THE PEOPLE...	SO I DECIDED THIS REVEALS...	BECAUSE...
BUILD · REVISE · CHALLENGE "I agree / would revise that because ____"			

PARTNERS · TALK IT OUT TOGETHER, EACH OF YOU WRITES

2 LOOK ON pp. 8–9 the war news, the Fascists take power, German troops enter Hungary, the report from Budapest		
3 LOOK ON pp. 9–12 German soldiers arrive in Sighet; the leaders are arrested, new decrees, the ghettos		

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 5 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 2 OF 5

SAY WHILE DOING

(Slide 9) "You already read this. You are not finding ten new quotes. Look on the pages flagged in column one. Find the warning, find what the town does with it, then do the hard part: what does it reveal? Talk it out. Each of you writes."

SCHOLARS DO

Partners fill Rows 2–3: warning + page, reaction + page, inference. Mark W / R on the printed pages as they go.

BRIGGS CHECKS

1 "What exactly were they told?" · 2 "What did they actually do or say? Page?" · 3 "You told me what they did. What does that reveal?"

WHEN STUCK

"Talk me through how you got there." → "Go back to the text. What made you say that?" → "What part are you sure about?" → then point to the paragraph.

MISCONCEPTION 1

Column 3 repeats column 2 → "You told me what happened. What does it reveal about people?"

MISCONCEPTION 2

"They're stupid." → "That is a judgment. What does the text actually show about WHY they dismiss the danger?" p. 9: "it was all in the abstract."

MOREHOUSE

Same rows, same endpoint. If a pair stalls, put a finger on the paragraph: Row 2 → p. 9, "Yet we still were not worried." Row 3 → p. 10, the chocolates, or p. 11, "It's not lethal." Let them say the reaction out loud, then ask, "So what does that reveal?" Don't write it for them.

PACE CALLS

38 "Row 2 should have its inference." · **42** "You should be on Row 3's inference." · **44** "Finish your sentence."

MOVE ON WHEN

Most pairs have an inference in both rows. Don't wait for perfect; the go-over is next.

TRANSITION

"Pencils up. Eyes here. I want to hear your inferences, not your summaries."

Grounding · pp. 8–12

Row 2: Spring 1944. Hungary's government goes pro-Nazi; German troops enter Hungary; a friend reports fear and attacks in Budapest. The town worries briefly, then: "Optimism soon revived" (p. 9).

Row 3: German soldiers move into Sighet and are polite; an officer brings chocolates (p. 10). Then, fast: leaders arrested, valuables seized, the yellow star, curfews, the ghettos (pp. 10–11). Inside the ghetto, people feel relieved: "ruled by delusion" (p. 12).

PACKET PAGE 2 · ROWS 2–3

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

03 WARNING REACTIONS CHART
Warning → reaction → what the reaction reveals about people. LENS 1

REREAD pp. 5–7. Mark your printed pages: **W** warning
R reaction **?** something to discuss

Column 3 is not a summary. It answers: what does this reaction reveal about what people do with unbearable news?

THE WARNING + PAGE	THE COMMUNITY'S REACTION + PAGE	INFERENCE: WHAT THIS REVEALS ABOUT PEOPLE
M pp. 6–7 · MOISHE Moishe escapes the Galician forest and comes back to describe what the Gestapo did there: "I wanted to come back to warn you." (p. 7)	People "not only refused to believe his tales, they refused to listen." Some said he wanted pity or was imagining things. Others said he had gone mad. (p. 7)	<i>We build this one together.</i>

SHOW YOUR THINKING · THINK FIRST, THEN SAY IT
Okay, now I need the inference. What does their reaction to Moishe reveal about people?

FIRST I NOTICED...	THEN I NOTICED THE PEOPLE...	SO I DECIDED THIS REVEALS...	BECAUSE...

BUILD · REVISE · CHALLENGE "I agree / would revise that because _____"

PARTNERS · TALK IT OUT TOGETHER, EACH OF YOU WRITES

2 LOOK ON pp. 8–9 the war news, the Fascists take power, German troops enter Hungary, the report from Budapest		
3 LOOK ON pp. 9–12 German soldiers arrive in Sighet, the leaders are arrested, new decrees, the ghettos		

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 2 OF 5

SAY WHILE DOING

"Row 2. I need three people: one gives the warning, one gives the reaction, one gives the inference." Repeat for Row 3. Chart it on the WARNING → REACTION → INFERENCE anchor chart.

LISTEN FOR · ROW 2

Warning: Fascists in power, German troops in Hungary, the Budapest report (p. 9). Reaction: "Yet we still were not worried"; "Optimism soon revived" (p. 9). Inference: people keep danger abstract until it is at their door.

LISTEN FOR · ROW 3

Warning: soldiers arrive, leaders arrested, decrees (pp. 9–11). Reaction: the chocolates, "still smiling" (p. 10); "It's not lethal" (p. 11); the ghetto feels like relief (pp. 11–12). Inference: people adjust to each step and call it normal.

BUILD

After each inference: "Who can build on or revise that?"

PRESS

"You told me what they did. What does that reveal?" · "What are they protecting themselves from having to believe?" · "At what point does disbelief become dangerous?" Wait. **Don't answer these yourself.**

LISTEN FOR

From having to leave, give up their life, or believe people could do this. Disbelief becomes dangerous when it costs the chance to act: the emigration certificates (pp. 8–9), Moishe's "I warned you" (p. 10).

IF INCOMPLETE

"Okay. So what?" · "Go back to the text. What made you say that?"

MOVE ON WHEN

Two rows are charted with inferences, or 50:00.

TRANSITION

(Slide 10) "That's lens one, people. Now lens two, language. Last night I only asked you to NOTICE a pattern. Today we figure out what the pattern might mean. Page 3."

PACKET PAGE 3 · DEFINITION + ROW M

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

NIGHT TRACKER
Last night you noticed the word. Today we figure out what the pattern might mean. LESS 3

SYMBOLISM = when a concrete image, word, object, or repeated detail carries a larger idea beyond its literal meaning.

WHERE "NIGHT" APPEARS, pp. 11–22: p. 12 · p. 14 · p. 18 · p. 21 · p. 22. Start with the ones you marked for homework.

PAGE	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT "NIGHT" MIGHT SYMBOLIZE BEYOND LITERAL DARKNESS
M p. 12 "Night fell."	Neighbors gather in the courtyard. Elie's father is suddenly called to a special Council meeting. "The story he had interrupted would remain unfinished."	Watch Ms. Briggs think it through. Then write.
2 p. ____		
3 p. ____		
4 p. ____ if time		

PATTERN SENTENCE
Night keeps arriving with _____.
so Wiesel may be building "night" into a symbol of _____.

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 3 OF 5

SAY WHILE DOING

(Slide 10) "Last night I only asked you to NOTICE the pattern. Today we figure out what the pattern might mean." Point to the definition: "**Symbolism** is when a concrete image, word, object, or repeated detail carries a larger idea beyond its literal meaning."

MODEL · ROW M

(doc cam) "p. 12: 'Night fell.' Literally, it got dark. Now, what is happening around it? Neighbors are gathered, my father is telling stories, and right then he is pulled away to an emergency meeting. 'The story he had interrupted would remain unfinished.' So in this moment, night shows up right when the normal evening breaks. I'm going to write: *night comes when ordinary life gets interrupted, maybe the beginning of the end of safety*. I said **maybe**. One row isn't a pattern yet."

SCHOLARS DO Copy the model thinking into column 3 in their own words.

DON'T Don't write "night = death / evil / fear" anywhere. Don't post a symbol. The power is the pattern coming from their own rows. **PRATHER**

MISCONCEPTION 3 "It just means it's nighttime." → "Literally, yes. Now look at what keeps happening around the word. What larger idea is beginning to travel with it?"

MOVE ON WHEN Row M is copied. About 6 minutes.

TRANSITION "Use the pages you marked last night. Two more rows. Literal first, then what's happening, then what it might mean. Go."

Grounding · night on p. 12

What is happening: An ordinary evening in the ghetto; neighbors in the courtyard; Elie's father is telling stories. A policeman calls him to an emergency Council meeting. He comes back near midnight with one word: "Transports" (p. 13).

Why it matters: "Night fell" is the first time in the reading that night arrives with the danger. Early on, night meant prayer and study (pp. 3, 8). That change is the pattern scholars will find.

PACKET PAGE 3 · ROWS 2–4

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

04 NIGHT TRACKER
Last night you noticed the word. Today we figure out what the pattern might mean. LENS 3

SYMBOLISM = when a concrete image, word, object, or repeated detail carries a larger idea beyond its literal meaning.

WHERE “NIGHT” APPEARS, pp. 11–22: p. 12 · p. 14 · p. 18 · p. 21 · p. 22. Start with the ones you marked for homework.

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M p. 12 “Night fell.”	Neighbors gather in the courtyard. Elie’s father is suddenly called to a special Council meeting. “The story he had interrupted would remain unfinished.”	Watch Ms. Briggs think it through. Then write.
2 P. ____		
3 P. ____		
4 P. ____ If time		

PATTERN SENTENCE
Night keeps arriving with _____.
so Wiesel may be building “night” into a symbol of _____.

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 3 OF 5

SCHOLARS DO Rows 2–3 (Row 4 if time): page, what is happening, what night might symbolize. Partners may talk; each writes.

CHECK Column 2 is the scene, not a definition. Column 3 goes beyond darkness **and** is tied to what’s happening in that scene.

LISTEN FOR p. 14: the knock “that night,” the escape they missed · p. 18: “the last night spent in our house” · p. 21: “No one was praying for the night to pass quickly” and the fire “consuming us” · p. 22: the last family meal, a sleepless night.

IF STALLED “Don’t jump to the symbol yet. What pattern do you actually see?” · “What is happening to the family every time it gets dark?”

MISCONCEPTION 4 “What’s the right answer?” → “Can you defend your interpretation from the pattern in the text?”

MOREHOUSE Point to the page bank: start with p. 18 (“the last night spent in our house”). Read the sentence with them; ask, “What are they losing here?” Let them say it, then write it.

DONE EARLY Stretch: “Go back to p. 3. What did night mean to Elie before? What changes by p. 21?” Or track what night is paired with each time (silence, fire, leaving) and decide which pairing carries the most weight. **PRATHER**

PACE CALLS 60 “Row 2 should be done.” · **63** “Finish Row 3’s last column.”

RUNNING LONG? Stop at Row 3. The go-over is not optional.

TRANSITION | “Pencils up. Let’s see if we all found the same pattern.”

PACKET PAGE 3 · PATTERN SENTENCE

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

04 NIGHT TRACKER
Last night you noticed the word. Today we figure out what the pattern might mean. LENS 3

SYMBOLISM = when a concrete image, word, object, or repeated detail carries a larger idea beyond its literal meaning.

WHERE "NIGHT" APPEARS, pp. 11–22: p. 12 · p. 14 · p. 18 · p. 21 · p. 22. Start with the ones you marked for homework.

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4 p. ____ If time		

PATTERN SENTENCE
Night keeps arriving with _____.
so Wiesel may be building "night" into a symbol of _____.

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 3 OF 5

ASK · 1 "What kinds of events keep happening when night appears?" Chart their answers on the blank NIGHT chart, with pages.

LISTEN FOR Bad news, leaving home, a missed escape, the last family meal, fire, not being able to sleep.

ASK · 2 "What pattern are you seeing?" Then: "What could 'night' begin to represent beyond darkness?"

LISTEN FOR Defensible, tied to the chart: loss · the end of safety · the end of normal life · fear of the unknown · time running out · the world they knew collapsing.

DON'T Don't announce one official answer. If two readings both fit the evidence, say so: "Both of those come from the pattern. Defend yours."

WRITE · 1 MIN Scholars finish the pattern sentence: "Night keeps arriving with _____, so Wiesel may be building 'night' into a symbol of _____."

CHECK Blank 1 names events from their rows; blank 2 is an idea, not "darkness."

MOVE ON WHEN 69:00. Writing time is next; protect it.

TRANSITION (Slide 11) "You now have two charts full of evidence. Page 4. Pick the prompt that matches your strongest chart."

PACKET PAGE 4 · BOX 05

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

05 FOCUSED ANALYTICAL WRITE
Choose ONE prompt. Use your charts on pages 2–3. 10–12 MIN

☐ **PROMPT A · HUMAN NATURE**
What does the community's response to the warnings reveal about human nature? Use evidence from the opening of *Night*.

☐ **PROMPT B · SYMBOLISM**
What might Wiesel's repeated use of "night" symbolize in the opening of the memoir? Use evidence from the text.

REQUIRED

☐ **Claim:** What are you arguing?
☐ **Evidence:** one strong line or detail + page
☐ **Reasoning:** why that evidence supports your claim

TALK FIRST. Say your claim out loud to your partner in one sentence. Then write.

NEED A START? The community responds by _____. This reveals that people may _____ when _____. Wiesel uses "night" when _____ is happening. This may symbolize _____ because _____. This evidence supports my claim because _____.

MY RESPONSE

DONE EARLY? Add a second piece of evidence and the reasoning that goes with it.

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 4 OF 5

SAY WHILE DOING

(Slide 11) "Choose ONE. Prompt A if your warning chart is stronger, Prompt B if your night chart is. You need a claim, one strong piece of evidence with a page, and reasoning that explains why it proves your claim. Claim, evidence, reasoning. Done early? Add a second evidence and reasoning."

TALK FIRST · 1 MIN

"Turn to your partner. Say your claim in one sentence. Partner, if it sounds like a summary, say 'So what?'" Then silence.

SCHOLARS DO

Write independently, using the charts on pp. 2–3 as their evidence bank.

LOOK FOR

A claim that answers the actual question (human nature or symbolism), not a retelling; a quote or detail with a page; reasoning that explains rather than repeats. **PRATHER**

WHISPER ONLY

Misconception 5: "You found the line. What does it prove?" · Summary claim: "You gave me what happened. I need what it reveals."

MOREHOUSE

Stems are on p. 4. Point; don't read them aloud for the scholar. The claim and the inference are theirs.

TIME

Eight minutes on the clock. If the debriefs ran fast, give 10–12. If the block ran long, finish at home.

TRANSITION

(Slide 12) "Pencils down. Turn to page 5. Exit ticket. On your own."

PACKET PAGE 5 · EXIT TICKET

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · NIGHT BY ELIE WIESEL DAY 4

CUT OR FOLD HERE EXIT TICKET ON YOUR OWN

06 · EXIT TICKET · ANSWER THE ONE MS. BRIGGS CHOOSES NAME

☐ A. One warning the people of Sighet fail to take seriously is _____. Their reaction reveals _____ about people.

OR

☐ B. So far, Wiesel's repeated use of "night" may symbolize _____ because _____.

MY ANSWER

WEEK 9 · DAY 4 · ENCOUNTERING EVIL · GRADE 8 ELA · MS. BRIGGS PAGE 5 OF 5

CHOOSE More time on warnings today → **A**. More time on symbolism → **B**. Say it once: "Check box A" or "Check box B."

SAY | "One answer. Silent, on your own. Use your charts if you need them."

LOOK FOR · A A real warning with what the reaction reveals, not what happened next.

LOOK FOR · B An idea beyond darkness with a "because" tied to the scenes.

COLLECT **Exit tickets.** The charts on pp. 2–3 stay in folders; Day 5's synthesis uses every chart from this week. **PRATHER** Unfinished focused writes go home.

SORT TONIGHT Three piles: inference / symbol solid · shaky · summary only. The shaky pile is tomorrow's first conference list.

IF YOU'RE BEHIND | **The exit ticket still happens, even at two minutes.**